THE FIRST 72 HOURS

A calm, child-centered starting checklist

■ Prioritize immediate safety and children's day-to-day needs. If anyone is in danger, seek emergency assistance.

■ Write down time-sensitive appointments, hearings, and deadlines. Confirm details with qualified professionals.

■ Gather your own financial and household records lawfully. Do not access anyone else's accounts or devices without permission.

■ Make a practical list of your children's schedules, medications, schools, and routines.

■ Avoid posting about the separation or conflict on social media.

■ Write down questions for a family-law attorney or mediator in your jurisdiction.

■ Identify one trusted person for emotional support and plan your next week of parenting responsibilities.

Educational information only. Not legal or mental-health advice. Circumstances and laws vary. © 2026 Divorced Dads Now